

FOSS Yellow Pages.com ^{BETA}

“With FOSSYellowPages.com going LIVE, all CIOs and IT heads who were looking for open source vendor support, will be able to take faster decisions.”

Since the LFY team worked together to ideate and launch FOSSYellowPages.com, we thought of interviewing the team, and asking them the questions that many of you may have on your mind.

Q Why should I register my firm on FOSSYellowPages.com? What are the benefits?

Not been able to figure that one out? No problem. The answer is simple—a listing in FOSSYellowPages.com will enable you to get business from customers from across the world.

Plus, you will be able to invite proposals from principals, partners and consultants, who might be looking to team up with organisations that have experience in specific FOSS implementations.

Q Why do you think a listing on FOSSYellowPages.com will help us attract customers?

Good question. When we (the *LINUX For You* team) spoke to a number of CIOs and IT heads on why they were not adopting Linux and open

source, almost all of them said they didn't see much 'commercial support' for open source. As one CIO explained, "When it comes to open source, I don't know who will stick their necks out for the solution I am opting for, and there's no way I am going to put my neck on the block."

But then, there are hundreds of organisations that are offering open source support—so why don't these CIOs approach them and pay *them* to put *their* necks on the block? The answer, we figured out, lies in the fact that there is no medium that enables these CIOs to view and access all the vendors at one go. And what CIOs seem to hate is to buy a solution for which there are only a limited number of reputed vendors. This is understandable. If FOSS means independence and freedom from vendor lock-in, then how can they adopt a solution that will tie